

EMBA 8160: Generative Artificial Intelligence for Business

Syllabus for Fall 2026

Instructor: Péter Molnár

1 Course Details

The objective of this course is to prepare participants with a solid understanding of Generative AI's transformative potential and its implications for shaping the future of business and society.

1.1 Class Dates and Times

Session 1:	Friday, September 18th	5:00 – 9:30 PM
	<i>30 min break for dinner</i>	<i>7:00 – 7:30 PM</i>
Session 2:	Saturday, September 19th	2:00 PM – 6:00 PM
Session 3:	Saturday, October 3rd	2:00 PM – 6:00 PM
Session 4:	Saturday, October 17th	9:00 AM – 1:00 PM
Session 5:	Saturday, October 31st	9:00 AM – 1:00 PM
Session 6:	Saturday, November 7th	9:00 AM – 1:00 PM

1.2 Instructor

Instructor:	Dr. Péter Molnár
Email:	pmolnar@gsu.edu
Office Phone:	(404) 413-7713
Office hours:	TBA & by Appointment
Buckhead Office:	Buckhead Center, Room #626
Downtown Office:	35 Broad Street, Room #906

During the term, it is highly recommended that you contact the instructor, in-person or via email. They are available to help you focus your projects, gain access to resources, and answer your questions. Please try to contact them at least once during the term to discuss your project. Your class members are also a good source of help.

1.3 Course Website

Class information will be posted on the iCollege site. There will be links to other websites with course related material.

2 Overview

This course offers an immersive introduction to Generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) and its implications for modern businesses. Participants will delve into the historical context and fundamental concepts of (Generative) AI, exploring its evolution and impact on various industries. Through interactive discussions, case studies, and hands-on activities, students will gain a comprehensive understanding of key concepts such as neural networks, generative models, and the practical applications of transfer learning and prompt engineering.

Throughout the course, participants will explore the diverse applications of Generative AI, including creative content generation, natural language processing, and healthcare advancements, while analyzing real-world case studies to understand implementation challenges and ethical considerations. Engaging in group activities and discussions, students will refine their problem-solving skills, foster collaboration, and explore strategies for integrating Generative AI into existing business frameworks. Additionally, discussions on ethical practices and responsible AI will underscore the importance of transparency and fairness in AI-driven decision-making processes.

2.1 Learning objectives

Upon successful completion of this course, you will accomplish the following objectives and outcomes. In particular, students who complete this course will gain “Ready for work” skills, including:

1. Understand the historical context and fundamental concepts of Generative AI.
2. Build AI systems.
3. Explore applications of Generative AI across industries, including creative content generation, natural language processing, and healthcare.
4. Analyze real-world case studies to understand implementation challenges and ethical considerations.
5. Refine problem-solving skills and foster collaboration through group activities and discussions.
6. Develop strategies for integrating Generative AI into existing business frameworks responsibly and ethically.

3 Schedule

The course schedule is shown in Table 1. However, the topics and readings may change according to the interests and abilities of the class. Tables 2 and 3 show the dates for quizzes and project deliverables.

Materials may be updated 24 hours prior to class; please check before attending class.

Table 1: **Course Schedule**, Times are subject to change.

Date	Time	Topic
18-Sep	5:00-7:00PM	Intro Generative AI: This session introduces Generative AI, covering its background, historical context, and the fundamentals of AI development. It also provides an overview of prompt engineering techniques for generating text and images, setting the foundation for understanding AI's capabilities and applications. Lecture

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Table 1: **Course Schedule**, Times are subject to change. (Continued)

Date	Time	Topic
	7:30-9:00PM 9:00-9:30PM	Dinner Lecture & Activity Reflection
19-Sep	2:00-4:00PM 4:00-6:00PM	Agentic AI Systems: This session covers AI Systems that combine Generative AI with other functions. It covers concepts and tools to build Agentic AI Systems. Lecture Hands-on Exercise
3-Oct	2:00-2:30PM 2:30-3:30PM 3:30-4:00PM 4:00-5:00PM 5:00-6:00PM	Strategic Applications of Generative AI in Business: The session explores strategic uses of generative AI in business, focusing on high-impact opportunities across various industries like marketing, customer service, and product development. It includes case studies of successful AI-driven transformations in sectors such as healthcare, finance, and retail, highlighting real-world applications and value. Additionally, the session presents frameworks to help businesses decide whether to build or purchase generative AI solutions, equipping participants with criteria to evaluate the best approach for their needs. Progress report of AI Systems Projects Lecture Discussion Team Activity Presentation & Conclusion
17-Oct	9:00-9:30AM 9:30-10:30AM 10:30-11:00AM 11:00AM-12:00PM 12:00-1:00PM	Operationalizing Generative AI – Integration and Customization: The session focuses on integrating generative AI into current enterprise systems and workflows, emphasizing practical steps for embedding AI smoothly within existing structures. It examines the choice between customizing generative AI models for specific business needs versus using readily available tools. Additionally, the session covers the role of data feedback loops in continuously improving AI performance, highlighting how ongoing data integration refines model accuracy and effectiveness over time. Quiz 1 Lecture Discussion Team Activity Presentation & Conclusion

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Table 1: **Course Schedule**, Times are subject to change. (Continued)

Date	Time	Topic
31-Oct		Risk Management and Ethical Considerations in Generative AI: The session addresses the critical aspects of risk management and ethics in generative AI, focusing on data privacy, security, and intellectual property concerns. It covers ethical issues, including managing bias, preventing misinformation (AI "hallucinations"), and ensuring accountability in AI applications. Additionally, the session discusses relevant legal frameworks and regulatory considerations essential for businesses deploying generative AI, highlighting the importance of responsible and compliant AI integration.
	9:00-9:30AM	Quiz 2
	9:30-10:30AM	Lecture
	10:30-11:00AM	Discussion
	11:00AM-12:00PM	Team Activity
	12:00-1:00PM	Presentations & Conclusion
7-Nov		Leading Generative AI Transformation in Organizations: The session covers leadership strategies essential for promoting generative AI adoption within organizations, focusing on effective approaches to drive AI initiatives across teams and departments. It emphasizes the importance of building cross-functional teams to support AI projects and details change management techniques to secure organizational buy-in, ensuring a smooth transition and widespread support for generative AI transformation efforts.
	9:00-9:30AM	Quiz 3
	9:30-10:30AM	Lecture
	10:30-11:00AM	Discussion
	11:00AM-12:00PM	Team Activity
	12:00-1:00PM	Presentation & Conclusion

Table 2: **Quiz Schedule**, in class, on-paper

Quiz	Due Date	Topics
1	Saturday, Oct 17, 2026 (9:00–9:30AM)	Strategic Applications of Generative AI in Business
2	Saturday, Oct 31, 2026 (9:00–9:30AM)	Operationalizing Generative AI – Integration and Customization
3	Saturday, Nov 7, 2026 (9:00–9:30AM)	Risk Management and Ethical Considerations in Generative AI

Table 3: **Deliverables Schedule**, documents are to be submitted via iCollege.

Deliverable	Due Date	Type	Topic
Deployment on Server	Nov 7, 2026	individual	AI System Project
Presentation (PPTX or PDF)	Oct 3, 2026 (in class)	group	Strategic Applications of Generative AI in Business
Presentation (PPTX or PDF)	Oct 17, 2026 (in class)	group	Operationalizing Generative AI
Presentation (PPTX or PDF)	Oct 31, 2026 (in class)	group	Risk Management and Ethical Considerations in Generative AI
Presentation (PPTX or PDF)	Nov 7, 2026 (in class)	group	Leading Generative AI Transformation in Organizations

4 Required Resources

4.1 Textbooks

The landscape of Generative AI is still emerging and rapidly changing. So are the books. Additional reading recommendations will be posted on iCollege.

Suggested Readings

- "The Art of Prompt Engineering with chatGPT: A Hands-On Guide", Nathan Hunter, January 2023, ISBN 978-1739296711
- "Generative AI Transformation Blueprint", I. Almeida, November 2023, ISBN 978-0645977981
- "Artificial Intelligence Fundamentals for Business Leaders: Up to Date With Generative AI", I. Almeida, July 2023, ISBN 978-0645510553
- "Generative AI Business Applications: An Executive Guide with Real-Life Examples and Case Studies", David E. Sweenor and Yves Mulkers, February 2024, ISBN 979-8989337859

The two titles by I. Almeida are also available as 3-book collection with "Introduction to LLMs for Business Leaders: Responsible AI Strategy Beyond Fear and Hype", ISBN 978-0645510584

4.2 Compute Requirements

Class activities and assignments may require the use of a web browser for various applications. Either Google Chrome or Firefox should be installed on the computer. A full keyboard and trackpad or mouse are needed to efficiently write code. The browsers on Chrome Books and iPads may not fully support some of the web-interfaces. Students are encouraged to use their personal device instead of their work compute, since some corporate security installations may block certain external web-sites and internal, selfhosted applications. VPN access is needed to access some of the GSU resources. Visit <https://technology.gsu.edu/technology-services/cybersecurity/virtual-private-network/> to configure access to the GSU-VPN on your device. (You may seek help from the Technology Service Desk.)

5 Evaluation

Students are evaluated by the deliverables summarized in the table below:

Assignment	Percentage	Points
Quizzes (3)	15%	3 × 50
Project	45%	450
Team Activity, incl. presentation (4)	40%	4 × 100
Total	100%	1,000

Grading Scale:

A+	A	A-	B+	B	B-	C+	C	C-	D	F
97.0%- 100%	91.0- 96.9	89.5- 90.9	87.0- 89.4	83.0- 86.9	79.5- 82.9	77.0- 79.4	72.0- 76.9	69.5- 71.9	60.0- 69.4	Below 59.9

6 Assignments

The due dates and deliverables are posted in Table 3.

6.1 Team Activities

Team activities are carried out in class in sessions 3 through 6 and conclude with an in-class presentation by the team. The presentation is part of the team activity and is graded together with it; there is no separate presentation grade. **Team activities are group submissions:** one submission per team is required, via iCollege. All team members receive the same grade unless contributions are found to be unequal.

6.2 AI System Project

This project is about discovery and practicing skills. **The AI System project is an individual submission.** Projects are to be completed independently, though students are encouraged to discuss ideas and share tips with one another. Each project will be graded individually according to the posted rubric, assessing the work on its own merits.

7 Quizzes

All quizzes will be administered at the beginning of class. Quiz-forms on paper will be provided; students need to bring a pencil or (erasable) pen. Quizzes are in written answer form; closed books.

8 Use of Internet and Generative AI

The use of Generative AI tools is encouraged for research and preparation of reports and presentations. Any documents, including presentation decks, must indicate when and how Generative AI was used. The use of Generative AI tools is prohibited when taking quizzes or exams.

9 Student Expectations and Class Policies

Students should plan for 2 - 3 hours of work outside of class each week for each course credit hour. Thus, a 3-credit course averages between 6 and 9 hours of student work outside of the classroom, each week. See GSU site for Academic Success: <https://success.students.gsu.edu/>

9.1 Arbitration

There will be a one-week arbitration period after graded activities are returned. Within that one-week period, you are encouraged to discuss any assumptions and/or misinterpretations that you made on the activity that may have influenced your grade.

9.2 Attendance

Students are expected to attend all classes for the entire duration. During the scheduled class times, we will meet in the classroom (or on Zoom or WebEx if conditions require it. Invitations will be sent to all of you sometime before the meeting time via email). Given the compressed nature of the semester and the fact that there will be hands-on quantitative work as well as discussion, it makes sense for you to attend each session. Please notify me if you must miss a class. In any case, you are responsible for keeping up with anything you might have missed due to an absence. Every attempt will be made to make recordings of the class sessions available to you.

9.3 Submission of Deliverables

Unless specific, prior approval is obtained, no deliverable will be accepted after the specified due date.

If you have a legitimate personal emergency (e.g., health problem) that may impair your ability to submit a deliverable on time, you must take the initiative to contact the instructor before the due date/time (or as soon after your emergency as possible) to communicate the situation. Make-up exams will not be given: However, if a student has a planned absence, he or she may take the exam earlier with the permission of the instructor.

All assignments must be submitted using the designated mechanism that is specified in the assignment (usually via iCollege or ARC). Assignments via email will not be accepted.

9.4 Student Behavior

Behavior in class should be professional at all times. People must treat each other with dignity and respect in order for scholarship to thrive. Behaviors that are disruptive to learning will not be tolerated and may be referred to the Office of the Dean of Students for disciplinary action.

9.5 Discrimination and harassment

Discrimination and/or harassment will not be tolerated in the classroom. In most cases, discrimination and/or harassment violates Federal and State laws and/or University Policies and Regulations. Intentional discrimination and/or harassment will be referred to the Affirmative Action Office and dealt with in accordance with the appropriate rules and regulations. Unintentional discrimination and/or harassment is just as damaging to the offended party. But, it usually results from people not understanding the impact of their remarks or actions on others, or insensitivity to the feelings of others. We must all strive to work together to create a positive learning environment. This means that each individual should be sensitive to the feelings of others, and tolerant of the remarks and actions of others. If you find the remarks and actions of another individual to be offensive, please bring it to their attention. If you believe those remarks and actions constitute intentional discrimination and/or harassment, please bring it to my attention.

10 Official Department and University Policies

1. Prerequisites are strictly enforced. Students failing to complete any of the prerequisites with a grade of "C" or higher will be administratively withdrawn from this course with loss of tuition fees. There are

no exceptions, except as granted by the instructor with the approval of the department.

2. Students are expected to attend all classes and group meetings, except when precluded by emergencies, religious holidays, or bona fide extenuating circumstances.
3. Students who, for non-academic reasons beyond their control, are unable to meet the full requirements of the course should notify the instructor, by email, as soon as this is known and prior to the class meeting. Incompletes may be given if a student has ONE AND ONLY ONE outstanding assignment.
4. A "W" grade will be assigned if a student withdraws before mid-semester if (and only if) he/she has maintained a passing grade up to the point of withdrawal. Withdrawals after the mid-semester date will result in a grade of "WF". See the GSU catalog or registrar's office for details.
5. Spirited class participation is encouraged and informed discussion in class is expected. This requires completing readings and assignments before class.
6. All exams and individual assignments are to be completed by the student alone with no help from any other person.
7. Collaboration within groups is encouraged for project work. However, collaboration between project groups will be considered cheating.
8. Copying work from the Internet without a proper reference is considered plagiarism and subject to disciplinary action as delineated in the GSU Student Handbook.
9. Any non-authorized collaboration will be considered cheating and the student(s) involved will have an Academic Dishonesty charge completed by the instructor and placed on file in the Dean's office and the CIS Department. All instructors regardless of the type of assignment will apply this Academic Dishonesty policy equally to all students. Abstracted from GSU's Student Handbook Student Code of Conduct "Policy on Academic Honesty and Procedures for Resolving Matters of Academic Honesty" <https://codeofconduct.gsu.edu/>.

As members of the academic community, students are expected to recognize and uphold standards of intellectual and academic integrity. The University assumes as a basic and minimum standard of conduct in academic matters that students be honest and that they submit for credit only the products of their own efforts. Both the ideals of scholarship and the need for fairness require that all dishonest work be rejected as a basis for academic credit. They also require that students refrain from any and all forms of dishonorable or unethical conduct related to their academic work.

Students are expected to discuss with faculty the expectations regarding course assignments and standards of conduct. Here are some examples and definitions that clarify the standards by which academic honesty and academically honorable conduct are judged at GSU.

10.1 Plagiarism

Plagiarism is presenting another person's work as one's own. Plagiarism includes any paraphrasing or summarizing of the works of another person without acknowledgment, including the submitting of another student's work as one's own. Plagiarism frequently involves a failure to acknowledge in the text, notes, or footnotes the quotation of the paragraphs, sentences, or even a few phrases written or spoken by someone else. The submission of research or completed papers or projects by someone else is plagiarism, as is the unacknowledged use of research sources gathered by someone else when that use is specifically forbidden by the faculty member. Failure to indicate the extent and nature of one's reliance on other sources is also a form of plagiarism. Any work, in whole or part, taken from the Internet or other computer based resource without properly referencing the source (for example, the URL) is considered plagiarism. A complete reference is required in order that all parties may locate and view the original source. Finally, there may be

forms of plagiarism that are unique to an individual discipline or course, examples of which should be provided in advance by the faculty member. The student is responsible for understanding the legitimate use of sources, the appropriate ways of acknowledging academic, scholarly or creative indebtedness, and the consequences of violating this responsibility.

10.2 Cheating on Examinations

Cheating on examinations involves giving or receiving unauthorized help before, during, or after an examination. Examples of unauthorized help include the use of notes, texts, or “crib sheets” during an examination (unless specifically approved by the faculty member), or sharing information with another student during an examination (unless specifically approved by the faculty member). Other examples include intentionally allowing another student to view one’s own examination and collaboration before or after an examination if such collaboration is specifically forbidden by the faculty member.

Unauthorized Collaboration. Submission for academic credit of a work product, or a part thereof, represented as its being one’s own effort, which has been developed in substantial collaboration with another person or source or with a computer-based resource is a violation of academic honesty. It is also a violation of academic honesty knowingly to provide such assistance. Collaborative work specifically authorized by a faculty member is allowed.

10.3 Falsification.

It is a violation of academic honesty to misrepresent material or fabricate information in an academic exercise, assignment or proceeding (e.g., false or misleading citation of sources, the falsification of the results of experiments or of computer data, false or misleading information in an academic context in order to gain an unfair advantage).

10.4 Multiple Submissions.

It is a violation of academic honesty to submit substantial portions of the same work for credit more than once without the explicit consent of the faculty member(s) to whom the material is submitted for additional credit. In cases in which there is a natural development of research or knowledge in a sequence of courses, use of prior work may be desirable, even required; however the student is responsible for indicating in writing, as a part of such use, that the current work submitted for credit is cumulative in nature.